

History

U.S.





About the Course

Read United States history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.



Placement & Combining Tips

History courses are on a four-year rotation. Students should follow the current Alveary rotation.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2-3	History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) 1 time/week 20 min	Escape by Night: A Civil War Adventure Dandelions Buffalo Bird Girl: A Hidatsa Story Coolies Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)				
				History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)



Escape by Night: A Civil War Adventure



Dandelions



Buffalo Bird Girl: A Hidatsa Story



Coolies



Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)

∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 1

Kentucky

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Have you heard the name Abraham Lincoln? What do you know about him? He was the 16th President of the United States. However, no one would have assumed a boy born in a log cabin and who barely went to school would grow up to become the President. This is the story of his life.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Log cabin

This is a replica or copy of the one-room log cabin that Abraham Lincoln was born in. What would be hard about living in there with your family? You can see the inside of a cabin in your book.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas p.14-15

Find Kentucky. This is where Abraham Lincoln was born.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-14 "It was a" - "was only seven."

- How is Abraham's life different from yours?
- How was life harder back then in the 1800s?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photograph of Abraham Lincoln

You can use this for your timeline.

WEEK 2 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 2

Indiana, His Good Stepmother

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ RECAP

What have you learned about Abe Lincoln so far?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Indiana. They are moving to another state. Which direction is Indiana from Kentucky?

2.p.91 What river makes up the border between Kentucky and Ohio? (Ohio River)

→ INTRO

How did people cross rivers in those days when there weren't many bridges? One way is a log raft ferry similar to the one in the picture.

∞ Image Link: Log raft ferry

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-26 "Summer days went" - " school start up."

- What kinds of hardships has Abe already faced when he was just a boy?
- What signs of hope was there in his life?

→ VIEW

Describe the kind of work that is going on in the picture on p.18-19. Would you enjoy doing that kind of work in order to live?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 3 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

His Good Stepmother, The River and the Law

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Why do you think as many people didn't know how to read back then? (few schools, books are hard to find, busy trying to survive) What advantage would someone have who knew how to read?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas p.10-11

In the last chapter, we read about Abe and his family crossing the Ohio River. Now Abe is going to travel on the Mississippi. Trace the route from the Ohio River in Indiana to where the Mississippi River flows into the ocean. Do you know what city and state it flows through? (see p.14-15- New Orleans, Louisiana) You will find out more about that city in this chapter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-35 "The winter Abe" - "about moving again." (You may want to stop throughout the reading to have your student narrate)

- Why do you think Abe was so interested in reading?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Painting of a steamboat

WEEK 4 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

1830

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Springfield, Illinois. Abe and his family are moving around that area.

2.Which direction is are they traveling from Indiana?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-46 "February 12" - "mastered the rules."

- What do you think would be the hardest part of moving to a new area and starting again?
- What do you think Mr. Rutledge meant, "All he lacks is culture to reach a high place in life?"

→ VIEW

Image Link: Prairies of Illinois

• DEFINITIONS

unwieldy: not easy to manage or control (p.38)

yarns: a tall tale (p.38)

WEEK 5 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

1830, Mary Todd

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

If you don't know how to do something or don't know much about a subject, what steps would you take to learn about it? When Abe didn't know about something, he read a book about it. And that was at a time when it was hard to find books. If you remember, he didn't even finish one year of formal school.

• EXTRA HELPING

Video Link: This video shows the New Salem historical site where they reconstructed the town where Abe lived in the 1830s.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-56 "By spring" - "the Edwards' house."

- What stands out to you about the character of Abe?
- What characteristics seem to set him apart from other people?

WEEK 6 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 6

Mary Todd, Lawyer

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

When we think of famous people from the past we often think that everything just went well for them and they went straight to the top. But as we can see with Lincoln, there are a lot of setbacks and discouragements along the way.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-67 "November 4" - "his own state."

- Discuss some of the challenges and obstacles Abe faced and how he responded to them.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Home of Lincoln and Mary that they lived in from 1844 to 1861, when he became President. It is a historic site you can visit.

WEEK 7 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 7

President

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of US in 1854

1. Look at the map key. What does orange mean? What does green mean?
2. Where are most of the states that allow slavery located? Why do you think that is the case?

We will read about a series of debates between Lincoln and Stephen Douglas that made Lincoln a household name across the country. Here is the question they were discussing: How do the new states decide if they will allow slavery or be a free state? These debates were very exciting for the people of Illinois. It was like a sporting event with crowds, music and souvenirs.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-75 "One spring day" - "into the fog."

- What are some of the differences between Lincoln and Douglas?
- Do you think Douglas was surprised that Lincoln did so well in the debates? What do you think prepared him for these moments?

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Life-size bronze statues of Lincoln and Douglas at their 8th debate in Alton, Illinois.

2. Did you catch the name they gave to Lincoln during his campaign—Honest Abe, the Rail Splitter? Even though he was now a lawyer, he had split rails in his youth, and this image of him showing hard work and self-reliance was something many voters could relate to. This is a color reproduction of an 1858 painting.

• DEFINITIONS

secede: to separate from a nation or state and become independent

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 8

1861

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Do you think it would be fun to be a child in the White House? Two of President Lincoln's sons lived in the White House. William was 11 and Tad was 8 when their dad became President. Tad was known for his antics around the White House. He once discovered how to make all of the White House bells ring at the same time—much to the surprise of the entire staff and residents of the building!

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas p.14-15

Find Washington, DC. This is where Lincoln is going to now that he is President. Which direction is it from Springfield, Illinois?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.77-86 "February,1861" - "the White House."

- Do you think being President of the US is a hard or easy job? Why or why not?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Confederate flag from 1861 housed in the Smithsonian

• EXTRA HELPING

This is a short video about the beginning of the war at Fort Sumter.

Video Link: Fort Sumter

WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 9

Emancipation

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Abraham Lincoln is considered by many to be the greatest US President. In this chapter, we will read about one of the things he did that makes him so great.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.87-93 "Freeing of the" - "Pursuit of Happiness."

2.Read the first paragraph of the Emancipation Proclamation.

(Emancipation means freeing from bondage. Proclamation is an official statement or announcement made by the government.

"That on the first day of January, in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and sixty-three, all persons held as slaves within any State or designated part of a State, the people whereof shall then be in rebellion against the United States, shall be then, thenceforward, and forever free; and the Executive Government of the United States, including the military and naval authority thereof, will recognize and maintain the freedom of such persons, and will do no act or acts to repress such persons, or any of them, in any efforts they may make for their actual freedom."

• EXTRA HELPING

This chapter mentioned the telegraph office. This video tells the history of the telegraph.

Video Link: History of telegraph

WEEK 10 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 10

At Gettysburg

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Pennsylvania. Where is it in relation to Washington, DC?

2.p.47 This is just a map of Pennsylvania. Find Gettysburg right over the southern border of the state. This area became a national cemetery for many soldiers that died and it was the place is where an important speech was given by President Lincoln called The Gettysburg Address. It begins

• DEFINITIONS

orator: a person who makes speeches and is very good at making them (p.94)

Term 1	
with the famous lines, "Four score and seven years ago." Score means 20. So he is referring to 87 years ago when the United States became its own country in 1776. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.94-103 "Only one of" - "feel any easier." ● Is there anything we can do to honor those who sacrificed their lives for the freedom of our country? → VIEW ∞ Image Link: Gettysburg National Military Park where the battle took place.	
WEEK 11	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 11 The Last Day Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography → RECAP What happened last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p. 104-109 "Friday, April 14," - "from the earth." ● What did you admire about President Lincoln? ● If you could ask him any questions, what would you ask? → VIEW ∞ Image Link: Statue of Lincoln at the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, DC. ● DEFINITIONS malice: desire to cause pain, injury, or distress to another(p.105) charity: love or kindness (p.105) ● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the book using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.
WEEK 12	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 12 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: ABRAHAM LINCOLN: AN INITIAL BIOGRAPHY

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 1 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 13

The Book

Materials: Escape By Night

PREP: You may want to read this article and share some of the content. It talks about the church in Augusta where President Woodrow Wilson's father pastored and how the church was used for a hospital. It was the inspiration for this book.

∞ Article Link: First Presbyterian Church of Augusta

→ INTRO

This book is historical fiction, which means it is a fictional (not true) story set during real events from history. This takes place during the Civil War. We don't always know what inspired an author to write a book, but in this case we do know. Read the Author's Note on p.116-119.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1.p.14-15 Find Georgia. What part of the country is that? Is that a free state or a slave state?

2.p.65 Now find Augusta, Georgia. (D6) Is it right across the border from what state? (South Carolina)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.3-11

→ VIEW

This is how the church and house looks today. You can visit it.

∞ Image Links: First Presbyterian Church, Childhood Home of Woodrow Wilson

WEEK 2 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 14

The One-Armed Soldier

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What happened in the first chapter?

→ INTRO

Do you know what kinds of transportation were available in the 1860s? (horses, carriages, steamboats, trains)

→ LOCATE

1.Look at the map at the beginning of the book. Find Presbyterian Church. It is on the corner of which streets?

2.Find Tommy's house. Where is it located?

3.Find the railroad depot. How many blocks from Tommy's house is it located?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.12-18

• Why do you think Tommy thought it was so important to find the man who lost the book?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 3 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 15

A Commonplace Book

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

What is the title of this chapter? Do you know what that is? You will find out if you don't already know!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 p.19-26

- Did you figure out what a commonplace book is? It normally a book to put in quotes or poems from books you are reading, but in this case, the soldier also put in his own poem. You will probably use a commonplace book when you get older to record quotes and poems that you enjoy.

• DEFINITIONS

sovereign: in control over all creation (p.23)

WEEK 4 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 16

Big Steve, Blessed Are the Peacemakers

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

It is important to understand some of the terms used in this book. A Yankee is a term for someone from the North, while a Confederate soldier was someone from the South.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-5 p.27-38

- Do you think Tommy might be right about the soldier being a Yankee?
- What would that mean if that was true?

• DEFINITIONS

chaplain: a religious leader who performs religious services for a military group (such as the army) or for a prison, hospital, etc.(p.32)

WEEK 5 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 17

Troubled, A Dream

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 p.39-53

- What do you think Tommy will do now that he knows Red is a Yankee soldier?

• DEFINITIONS

refugee: someone who has been forced to leave a country because of war or for religious or political reasons (p.40)

WEEK 6 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 18

Great Power, The Deal

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9 p.54-66

- What do you think Tommy should do? Why would it be a hard decision?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 7 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 19

Streams of Mercy, The Branded Hand

Materials: Escape By Night

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Ch.10-11 p.67-79

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 20

The Escape, Hunting a Slave

Materials: Escape By Night

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Ch.12-13 p.80-91

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 21

The Diversion, The Jubilant Bell

Materials: Escape By Night

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Ch.14-15

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 22

Farewell

Materials: Escape By Night

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Ch.16-Epilogue

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 11 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 23

WEEK 12 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 24

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.
QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: ESCAPE BY NIGHT

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 3		
WEEK 1	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 25 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 2	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 26 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 3	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 27 Main Idea/Subtitle Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl → INTRO Information → LOCATE → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.3-11 → VIEW ∞ Image Link: Reconstructed Earth Lodge	• DEFINITIONS immunity: alliance
WEEK 4	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 36	

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 3

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

· Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

Tell all you know about the story of Abraham Lincoln's journey from his childhood to becoming president during the Civil War.